

BC Environment

River Forecast Centre

Update – Flood Warning: Central Coast 19Oct2010 5:45PM

- Tributaries of the Bella Coola River
- Bella Coola River - added

The BC River Forecast Centre is continuing the Flood Warning for the Bella Coola valley. This warning now includes the mainstem of the Bella Coola River.

Environment Canada is maintaining the Rainfall Warning for the Central Coast – Coastal Sections. Although this Rainfall Warning does not include the Bella Coola valley, moderate to heavy precipitation (3-6 mm/hour) is continuing to be recorded at weather stations in the valley. The frontal system bringing precipitation to the Central Coast is continuing to stall, and the Environment Canada forecast is for moderate to heavy rainfall to continue into late this evening, easing overnight tonight. Forecast amounts are for an additional 10-15 mm this evening, 5 mm overnight, and 5-10 mm for Wednesday.

Given the weather forecast for continued rain this evening, river levels will continue to rise tonight, and are expected to peak overnight or early tomorrow morning. The mainstem of the Bella Coola River is also continuing to rise, and localized flooding may occur.

The River Forecast Centre will continue to monitor conditions and will provide an update Wednesday morning, or earlier if conditions warrant.

A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.